

Executive Summary

Onboarding Flow Optimization A/B Test

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The Question

The current 13-step onboarding flow completes at 60%, against an ~80% industry benchmark. We tested two shorter alternatives — **B (7 steps)** and **C (5 steps)** — against the current flow (**A, control**) to find out whether cutting steps closes that gap, and what it costs.

The Headline Result

Completion rate rises significantly at every step reduction.

Arm	Steps	Completion Rate	vs. Control
A — Control	13	57.4%	—
B — Medium	7	73.0%	+15.6 pp , $p < 0.0001$
C — Short	5	81.5%	+24.1 pp , $p < 0.0001$

No Sample Ratio Mismatch was detected (allocation was exactly 2,000 / 2,000 / 2,000 as designed), and the sample is well-powered — every observed difference is far above the 4.3-percentage-point minimum this sample size could reliably detect.

But It's Not a Clean Win for C

Arm C wins the most on completion — but it also shows measurable regressions the control doesn't, on exactly the guardrails this experiment was designed to watch:

Guardrail	A (Control)	C (Short)
Lesson relevance score	3.98 / 5	3.44 / 5
Support-ticket rate	0.9%	2.2%
Notification opt-in rate	52.8%	32.7%
Day-30 return rate	36.2%	29.0%

Arm B shows none of these regressions at comparable magnitude. Paid conversion rate, meanwhile, stays flat across all three arms (~6%) — confirming the checkout funnel itself was never the problem.

Recommendation

Ship Arm B. Hold Arm C for a follow-up experiment.

B captures most of the completion-rate opportunity (+15.6pp, ~890 additional paying users/month at illustrative volume) without the guardrail cost C carries. C should be revisited as a narrower experiment

investigating whether its additional step cuts can be made without the personalization and retention trade-offs observed here.

Full statistical methodology, all pairwise tests, and complete guardrail analysis: see [00_documentation.md](#) and the interactive dashboard ([dashboard/dashboard.html](#)).